

UNIT 3 Technology in our lives



Grammar:

Comparative and superlative adjectives
Relative clauses: *which, who, where, when*

Functions:

Talking about new technology and modern facilities

Vocabulary:

- shopping
- household gadgets and personal technology items
- quantity expressions

Learning strategies:

When I read a text, I try to...

- predict vocabulary by looking closely at the visuals in the unit

When I speak, I try to...

- recognise words which express opinion
- use set phrases to participate in a conversation
- use other people's opinion to make a decision

Lesson 1

Lead-in

AIMS

- To identify words to compare things
- To predict vocabulary
- To make students aware of the difference between fact and opinion
- To use the comparative and superlative.

1. Many people believe the phone was a good invention. What do you believe is the best invention? Why?

2. Look at the advertisements for three **portable multimedia players**. How are they different? Compare your ideas with your partner. Then, find the following information:

- Which has the biggest memory?
- Which is the lightest?
- Which two have longer lasting batteries?
- Which has the best features?

A

Memory 256 MB
62g
battery 40 hours
guarantee 2 years
counter

119 €



B

Memory 20 GB
115 g
battery 40 hrs
guarantee 1 year
big keyboard

359 €



299 €

C

Memory 20 GB
200 g
battery 5 hrs
colour screen
remote control



3. In pairs, read the description of each item and discuss the following: Why is **C** the most expensive? Which is the best buy? Why? Which has a better keyboard, **A** or **B**? Why? Why is **C** more expensive than **A**? Which has more features than the others?

4. We use **CD** for Compact Disc; **GB** means gigabyte; What do the following mean?

- | | | |
|---------------|--------------|-----------------|
| a) SMS _____ | b) MB _____ | c) Mp3 _____ |
| d) DVD _____ | e) www _____ | f) e-mail _____ |
| g) iPod _____ | | |

Task 1

Read the statements below and then in pairs make similar statements about electronic items you have at home such as the television, the CD player, the video recorder, the mobile phone, the computer.

A is good but B is better and C is the best.

The batteries in A and B last longer than the battery in C.

B is heavier than A and C is the heaviest.

B is more expensive than A and C is the most expensive.

My phone is bad, but John's is worse, and Rena's is the worst. It doesn't work at all!



Grammar Comparative and superlative adjectives

Look carefully at the example sentences in TASK 1 and in pairs complete the following grammar rules for the Comparative and Superlative forms.

You form the **comparative** by adding _____ to any one-syllable adjective. The following adjectives are exceptions to this rule:

- **good** becomes _____
- **bad** becomes _____

When the adjective is long (with two syllables or more) use _____ in front of the adjective.

To form superlative add _____ to any one syllable adjective at the end of the word. The following adjectives are exceptions to this rule:

- **good** becomes _____
- **bad** becomes _____

Any longer adjective (two syllables or more) use _____ in front of the word.

Usually we use _____ before the superlative adjective.

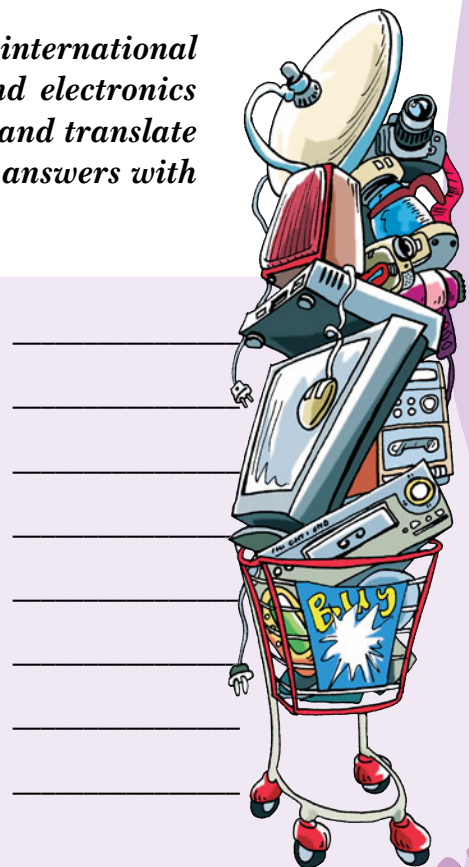
Task 2



Vocabulary

On a trip abroad, you went to an electronics shop at an international airport to buy an electronic item. You don't understand electronics jargon very well. Try to guess what the salesperson said and translate the words in **bold italics** into Greek. Then compare your answers with your partner. Write the meaning on the line provided.

- I have got the iPod Nano. Which **model** do you want?
- This **mobile phone** has got a video recorder.
- When you buy two of the same product, you get a **discount**.
- You have to wait in the **queue** to pay.
- If it's **faulty**, you can take it to any shop in your country to replace it.
- This stereo has a two-year **guarantee** and we repair it free of charge.
- We sell a range of quality **brand name** products at reasonable prices.
- We stock a variety of electronic **gadgets**.
- If it doesn't work, you can get a **refund**.



Lesson 1



Reading

Quiz: Let's buy it!

Do Part 1 of the following shopping quiz with your partner to find out who knows more about shopping. In order to find your score, give each answer a 1 point and each answer b 2 points. Check what the scores mean by looking at the scoring on page 29.

Compare your scores with your partner. Do you agree with the results of the quiz?

quiz quiz quiz quiz quiz QUIZ

What kind of shopper are you?

Part 1

1 When you buy a new cell phone, you choose

- a. A model which is better than your friend's
- b. A model that isn't as expensive as your friend's

2 You believe that

- a. Mobile phones are too expensive nowadays
- b. Mobile phones are cheaper than a year ago

3 When something is faulty with something you bought, you

- a. Feel too shy to go to the shop to complain
- b. Go back to the store and ask for a refund

4 When shopping for something you really like, you

- a. Ask for more discount than the shop is offering
- b. Don't care how much it costs and buy it anyway

5 In a huge store, you

- a. Queue up and wait your turn for someone to serve you
- b. Push your way through to the front and ask for service

6 The last time you went shopping, what you bought was

- a. The best model in the shop
- b. The least expensive model in the shop

7 When buying presents for friends, you

- a. Buy something because it has a brand name
- b. Buy something which is not too expensive but looks okay

8 A family member gives you a new mobile phone which you do not like, you

- a. Tell him it is wonderful
- b. Take it back to the shop and get it changed



9 When buying presents for family members, you

- a. Buy the first thing you see
- b. Spend a long time looking around



10 What is a good excuse for not buying your brother or sister a present

- a. I didn't have enough money
- b. What I wanted to get you was too expensive

Technology in our lives

Task 1

Tick the statements in PART 2 of the quiz that are TRUE for you. Are they TRUE for your partner too?

In pairs, read through the questions in PART 1 and the statements in PART 2 and explain to your partner the reason for your answers.

Task 2 - Comparison words

quiz quiz quiz quiz quiz QUIZ

Part 2 Tick the statements that you think are true

- a. Cassette players are not as good as CD's.
- b. Laptop computers are far too expensive for most young people to buy.
- c. More people have mobile phones in Greece than in England.
- d. I spend too much money on electronic goods.
- e. I do not have enough time to play games on my computer.
- f. Most high school kids don't know how to send an e-mail.
- g. SMS messages are quicker than e-mails.
- h. I know what SMS means.
- i. Not so many people know what www means.
- j. Watching television is a waste of time.



scoring

20 - 17 points

You are a very careful shopper and do not waste your money

16 - 13 points

You cannot live without electronic gadgets

12 - 8 points

You love shopping

7 - 3 points

You are not very good at shopping

1. Circle the words in the quiz which compare size and number.

Compare your answers with your partner's.

2. Think of three gadgets you have at home and compare them with three similar gadgets your partner has. Use the words you circled in the text to compare the gadgets.

Write your opinions in your notebook.

For example:
Is your... better/worse?
Was it more expensive?

Lesson 2



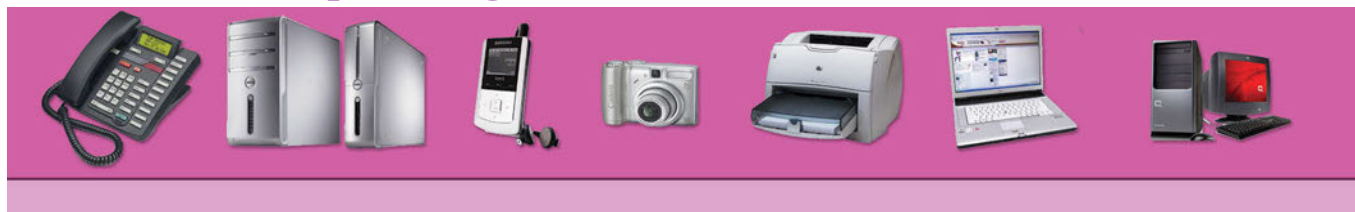
Listening &



Speaking

AIMS

- To listen for gist
- To listen for detail
- To recognise words which express opinion



Pre-listening

1. Look at the pictures of the electronic products above. Which countries produce these products?
2. Which do you think is the most useful for young people today?

Task 1 - Quiz

1. Your cousin got a new job with an electronics shop and she needs to become an expert in technology and its uses as soon as possible. Find out which of your classmates is the best to teach her.

Do the following quiz: Tick the facts about your knowledge of the different new technology items. You score a point for each one you tick.

I know how to:

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ use a computer | ☐ store addresses on mobile phones |
| ☐ plug in a printer | ☐ send SMS messages |
| ☐ install a program | ☐ change ink cartridges |
| ☐ charge batteries | ☐ copy images from phone to computer |
| ☐ download music from the web | ☐ copy images from internet |
| ☐ log onto the internet | ☐ find missed calls |
| ☐ send e-mail messages | ☐ download programs from internet |
| ☐ copy files on a CD | ☐ know what an mp3 is |

Now, go around the class to find out who has the most points. Don't cheat!

2. Look at the pictures of the electronic items. Do you know what each one is? Discuss your ideas with your partner. Write down your ideas for each item.



Task 2a - Listen to the advertisements

Listen to the advertisement of each product and fill in the missing information on the chart below.

Product	Manufacturer	Model	Battery life	Price	Advantages
DVD Player					
Ipod					
Camera					
MP3					
MP3 Watch					

Task 2b - Listen again

a. Listen to the ads again. Choose the phrase which each speaker uses to make each item sound attractive.

Who says what?



Speaker 1

Speaker 2

Speaker 3

Speaker 4

Speaker 5

- ☐ a. A truly valuable companion.
- ☐ b. The perfect item for all.
- ☐ c. An exciting new experience.
- ☐ d. A great buy at a really incredible price.
- ☐ e. The best you can buy at such a price.

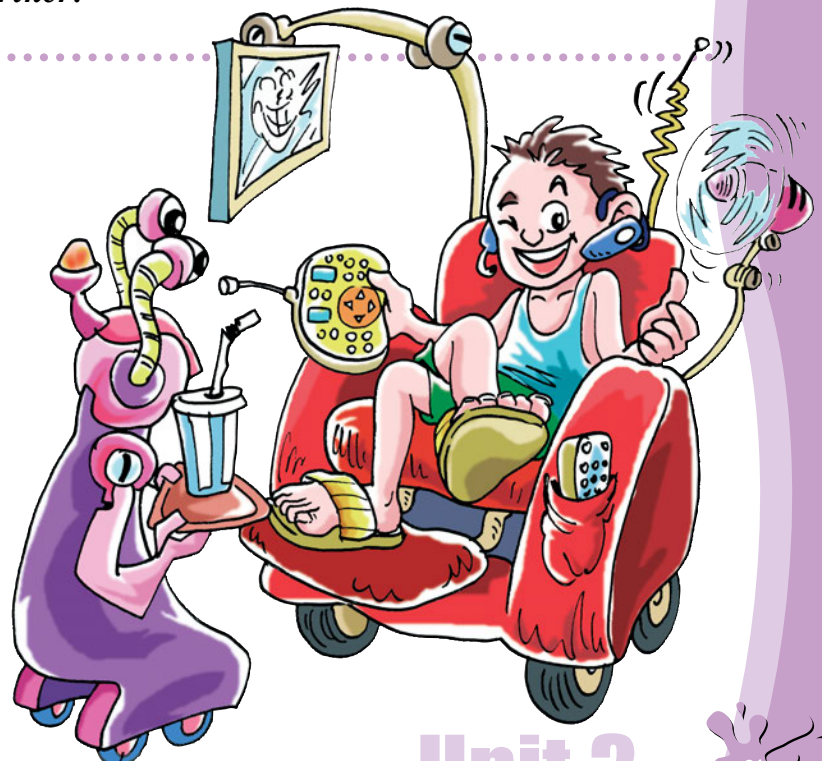
b. Compare your answers with your partner.

Task 3

1. Look at the sketch of the boy. In pairs, find:

- a) something that keeps him cool*
- b) something that he uses to play games*
- c) something that can help him at school*

2. Decide with your partner what feature of the chair is most useful for a teenage student. Why?



Lesson 2



Task 4 - Speaking

You want to buy presents for your family. Look at the seven items in the photographs. With your partner, decide who to give each present to at Christmas. You only have €350 to spend. Try, as much as possible, to use the language given in the box below.

Suggestions:

How about... for...?

We could give...

Why not give...?

I think... would like the...

Has... got a...?

Well, what about the... for...?

Responses:

Hm... I'm not so sure, as she...

Ah yes, you're right!

Sure. She might like that.

I don't think so.

I think... would like...

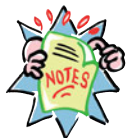
Perhaps, but she...

Yes, that's not a bad idea!



Explain your choices for each. With your partner, make a list of the things you look for when you buy a new product.

Compare your answers with the rest of the class. Who's the 'smartest consumer' of all?



Writing Pre-writing

Which electrical or electronic items might have the following problems?

- ✗ it doesn't start when you switch it on
- ✗ the sound from the speakers isn't very good
- ✗ the battery is always dead
- ✗ it stops with no reason
- ✗ the volume control doesn't work
- ✗ the screen/monitor is not clear
- ✗ it makes a noise when you turn it on
- ✗ the buttons stick
- ✗ the keyboard is very stiff
- ✗ the battery doesn't last long
- ✗ the hard drive crashes a lot



Dear Sir or Madam,

I recently bought a new DVD player which your assistant told me was the best on the market and excellent value for money. But when I brought it home and plugged it in, it didn't work. When I took it back to your shop, your assistant told me that there was no guarantee with this model and that there was nothing he could do. Obviously, I feel very angry with this situation and I would like an explanation.

I believe that it is your responsibility to refund my money or to replace the faulty DVD with a new one. I look forward to hearing from you.

Yours faithfully,
May Nicholls

Task 1 - Writing a letter

1. In pairs, read the formal letter on the right. Decide why the person is writing:

- ✗ to say hello
- ✗ to ask for advice
- ✗ to complain

2. In what order are the following points mentioned in the letter?

Write 1, 2, 3 in the appropriate boxes.

- | | |
|--|--------------------------|
| Asking that the company does something about the problem | ☐ |
| Complaining and expressing feelings | ☐ |
| Explaining the situation | ☐ |

Underline the expressions in the letter that the writer uses to complain.

3. How is a formal letter different from an e-mail? Discuss your answers in pairs. Use the information in the letter to write an e-mail. Compare your answers with your class.

4. Choose one of the problems in the PRE-WRITING activity and use the model letter to write an e-mail to complain about something you bought. Compare your letter with your partner. Does he/she feel your letter is good enough to get the manager to act?

Task 2 - Different lives

Look at the photographs below. Do you think life in this country is easier or more difficult than your life? Why? Why not? Why might a mobile-phone be a good present for someone who lives in this country?



Yuri is your pen-friend who lives in this country. Read his letter below to see what his problem is.

Dear Angelos,
Here are some photos of where I live. Although they are not very clear, I hope you like them.
In your last letter you suggested I buy my brother a mobile phone for his birthday but I don't know anything about them.
Can you help me please to decide which one to get him?
Best wishes,
Yuri.

Task 3 - Yuri's problem

Briefly discuss Yuri's problem with your partner.

Then decide which model of mobile phone you think is the best for him to buy.

Task 4 - Write a note

Write a short note to your pen-friend. Thank him for his letter and photographs and tell him why you think one cell-phone is better than another.

Start your note like this: Dear Yuri,
Thank you for ...

You can end your note with:
All the best for now,

Lesson 3

Making an advertisement

Project work - Make an advertisement

1. *An electronics company has asked your class to redesign some of their advertisements to make them more interesting and attractive for young people. You must use the basic information about the items but write them to appeal to young readers/shoppers.*

You must decide which aspects of the product to include as you only have limited space.

2. **Preparation**

Work in groups of 4 and appoint an editor in each group. In your group choose some products and discuss the following questions to complete the chart.



NEW ADVERTISEMENT

What product?				
Who for?				
What style?				
What theme?				
What photos?				
What words?				
What colours?				
What font?				

Use your notes to guide you to make an ad for one of these products.

3. **Research**

Look for similar ads in newspapers and magazines, on television or on the Internet. What techniques do they use to make the product attractive?

List the techniques of persuasion and advertising used in the adverts. Which ads use the following:

- music, humour, fame, guilt, stars, location, jingles, science
- association of ideas; before and after, desires, needs.

4. **The advertisement**

Make your own advertisement using your notes and the findings from your research. When your advertisements are complete, decide as a class which is the most appealing.

5. **Discuss with your partner the following question:**

Are adverts on TV more successful than adverts in magazines and newspapers? Why? Why not?

Self-evaluation

Activity A - Comparing electrical goods

Find out if the following are **TRUE** or **FALSE**. Look at a prospectus from an electronics shop, or ask your friends for their opinions.

	TRUE	FALSE
1. A DVD player can cost as much as an iPod.		
2. A hard drive is bigger than a floppy.		
3. A computer keyboard is easier to use than a typewriter.		
4. A laptop is smaller than a notepad.		
5. The most expensive gadget is not always the best.		
6. Batteries in iPods last longer than batteries in mobiles.		

___/3 points

Activity B

Write five new facts about electronic gadgets. Then ask your partner if he/she thinks your facts are true or not. Ask him/her why.

1.
2.
3.
4.
5.

___/2.5 points

Activity C

Complete the following conversation by choosing the correct phrase from the box.

Customer: I would like to see one of those new iPods please.
Sales Assistant: _____
Customer: Not really, just one that isn't too expensive.
Sales assistant: _____
Customer: Can you tell me something about it?
Sales Assistant: _____
Customer: Actually, I wanted something a bit better than that.
Sales Assistant: _____
Customer: Oh no, that's far too much. Maybe, I will leave it for a while.
Sales assistant: _____

- Okay, suit yourself. Bye.
- Oh, I see. Well, here's the cheapest model we have.
- How about this one? Only €350.
- Yes, sure. Any particular brand?
- Well, it plays music and that's about it.

___/2.5 points

Self-evaluation



Activity D

Match the solution to the problem with the computer. Look at the drawings and the text and match the solutions to the problems. Add one more problem that can happen with a computer system and find the solution.

Troubleshooting problems

1. The mouse doesn't move the cursor on the screen
2. When you type something, there is nothing on the screen.
3. You delete a file by mistake.
4. A message saying 'System Error' appears on the screen.
5. The printer doesn't print the document.
6. The cursor suddenly stops moving.
7. You can't save anything on the floppy disc.

Troubleshooting solutions

- A. There is a software problem. Press Ctrl+Alt+Delete then End the task to close the program. Then try to move the cursor.
- B. Check that the keyboard cable is connected to the computer.
- C. The disk might be full or damaged.
- D. Double-click the recycle bin icon. Select the file. Click on Menu and then click restore.
- E. You might have no paper, or the paper is stuck. Check the paper and then check the connection.
- F. Check that the mouse is connected properly.
- G. Turn off the computer and then turn it on again. If it still doesn't work, install the program all over again.

___/7 points

Activity E

Complete the following questions with any suitable word or words from the Unit.

- a. What is the gadget you have at home?
- b. Do you think a digital camera is a camera with film?
- c. Is the gadget always the?
- d. Your phone cost €35. Is that the phone there is?
- e. Which is; a CD or a DVD player?

___/5 points

Now tick how well you can do the following:

	With difficulty	Quite well	Easily
✓ I can read a text to select specific information	☐	☐	☐
✓ I can listen to dialogues to recognise attitude	☐	☐	☐
✓ I can take suggest and respond to ideas	☐	☐	☐
✓ I can write a letter to complain about a faulty item	☐	☐	☐